Fishery Notice

Category(s):

ABORIGINAL - General Information
COMMERCIAL - Invertebrates: Clam - Razor
COMMERCIAL - Invertebrates: Geoduck and Horseclam
COMMERCIAL - Invertebrates: Scallop by Trawl
COMMERCIAL - Invertebrates: Clam - Intertidal
RECREATIONAL - Shellfish
Sanitary/Other Contamination Closures
General Information
COMMERCIAL - Invertebrates: Oyster
AQUACULTURE - Shellfish

Subject:

FN0120-SANITARY - Area 17 - Emergency Closure for Bivalve Shellfish near Ladysmith

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Environment and Climate Change Canada (ECCC) recommends an emergency shellfish harvesting closure be put into effect per the below, as a result of a recently-reported leak of treated sewage from a point along an outfall, servicing the Town of Ladysmith wastewater treatment plant, in the vicinity of Holland Bank.

ECCC has reason to believe the sanitary conditions in the Conditionally Restricted area within Sanitary Closure 17.1, in the vicinity of Holland Bank, described below will be degraded to the point where accepted water quality standards of the CSSP have been exceeded. Given that overlay waters are a pathway by which pathogenic micro-organisms and other contaminants may be introduced into shellfish, ECCC concludes that the degree of contamination of the water may pose a risk to public health if the shellfish were harvested for consumption.

In accordance with Appendix VIII of the CSSP Manual of Operations, ECCC recommends that the following area be placed immediately in Closed Status under
Emergency closure to prevent the harvesting of potentially contaminated bivalve
shellfish. Licensed depuration and relay are now suspended by license condition
in the Conditionally Restricted area described as:

That portion of Ladysmith Harbour inside a line that starts at a point of land
at 48°58.71' north latitude and 123°47.92' west longitude, thence northerly to
a point in water at 48°58.94' north latitude and 123°47.77' west longitude, thence northwesterly to a point in water at 48°59.12' north latitude and 123°
48.04' west longitude thence westerly to a point on land at 48°59.13' north latitude and 123°48.38' west longitude, thence following the shoreline along
the high water mark to the point of commencement. [NAD 83]

This closure shall remain in place a minimum of 21 days, or 7 days if supported
by favourable verification sampling results, following the cessation of the leak from the outfall pipe, at which time ECCC will advise DFO if changes in
the status of this Emergency closure is warranted.

Note that this notice does not describe other sanitary closures which may be in
effect, or Paralytic Shellfish Poisoning (PSP, red tide) and other marine biotoxin closures.

Detailed bivalve shellfish closure information and maps are available at our
website: http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/contamination/biotox/index-eng.html

and at local DFO offices.

For more information contact a local DFO office or Elysha Gordon at 250-756-
7192.

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